SAMPLE

The Fate-Breaker

The Personality That Refuses the Script Written for It

Aiman Sterling

Free sample: Introduction & Chapter 1
putrabooks.github.io

Introduction

You know this person, or you are this person. the augury opens on its most *contrary* exhibit: the self whose whole biography is a refusal -- the family's entry, etched with the exasperation the oracle scroll has learned to hear underneath: *she was supposed to take over the firm -- the plan was made before she could walk, the school chosen, the chair with her name on it -- and she announced, at eighteen, that she was studying metallurgy, in a city none of us had heard of, and we have spent thirty years catching up to the woman the plan never predicted* -- the script, read, and declined, in one sentence. The pattern interrupted publicly -- the colleague's entry, held with the fascination the augury has learned to hear in it: *we had the whole quarter planned -- the launch, the timeline, the succession, all of it blessed three levels up -- and she voted no, alone, with reasons nobody had, and she was right, and I have watched her be right against the plan enough times to stop calling it contrarian and start calling it *sight* -- and the augury's dry note: the bent will accept *right* as a description; *prophetic* is refused like all the rest. And the strange joy of the unplanned outcome -- the friend's sentence, held with love and one permanent question: *she is the only person I know whose happiness visibly spikes when something goes off-script -- a canceled flight, a collapse, a sudden change -- everyone else groans and she lights up like the plan was a cage and the surprise is the door* -- and the wound the augury cannot close: the origin scene -- the torn prophecy: a future assigned -- the fate declared by family, prophecy, or paperwork -- and the child who read the script, all of it, with the strange early literacy of the conscripted -- and the ruling, made in the reading, never once revised: *this is not mine -- I am not the character they wrote -- the only fate I accept is the one I author* -- and the augury's founding finding, etched in the ink the whole book lives in: the Fate-Breaker is the catalog's freest person and the least *authored* one -- a self whose identity is written entirely in the *tearing*, a life of zigging where the zags were scheduled -- and the whole handwriting sample turns on the omen: the refusal was the *birth* -- and the refusal, the whole oracle scroll will show, is also the *ceiling*.

This is a case file on the Fate-Breaker: the personality that refuses the script written for it.

the origin scene is the assigned future, and the oracle scroll marks what makes it this catalog's most *quiet* origin: this is the one constitution built by *paperwork* -- the fate arrived as documents: the family firm's succession plan, drafted before the child could read; the prophecy, spoken over the cradle by whoever held the family's spiritual authority; the enrollment forms, the expectations, the whole life *pre-written* by people who loved the child and never once asked the child -- and the augury's most delicate omen, uniform across every handwriting sample: the script was *detailed* -- the bent could recite it, because the bent read it, early and completely, with the attention of a prisoner studying the wall -- and the tearing, when it came, was not rebellion in the ordinary sense: it was *literacy* -- the first fully self-authored act of a life that had been ghost-written: *no* -- and the clause the tearing wrote, the clause that becomes both the gift and the shadow: *every "meant to be" is a boundary to break* -- agency as war, permanent, total -- the self defined not by what it chose but by what it *refused* -- and the adult inherits the war at scale: the plan, declined on principle; the tradition, interrupted on sight; the destiny, dodged wherever recognized -- and the augury's central line on the handwriting: agency as war is not freedom; it is *reaction* -- a life navigated by the compass of *whatever they wrote, go the other way* -- and the whole biography is the war: the fate, escaped, and the self, *written by the escaping* -- because a biography defined against a script is still a biography *about the script*.

And what was the loom for? the oracle scroll answers with the tenderness every handwriting sample deserves: the child was solving for *ownership* -- the real scarcity of the origin scene was not choice; children have few; the scarcity was *authorship* -- the life, written by others, with the child cast as the *character* in someone else's story -- and the child's discovery, made in the reading of the script, before the age of reason, and never once wrong since: *the script's authors are not evil; they are merely *not me* -- and a life I did not write is a life I am not living* -- and the tearing, so dramatic from outside, was thus the plainest self-defense in this catalog: the child claimed the *pen* -- and the augury's most delicate omen: the claim was never completed -- the bent took the pen *away from them* and never once learned what the pen was *for* -- because the war against scripts has no ending, and the bent, mid-war, writes nothing: the moves are all *against*; the authored fate, the oracle scroll's mature cases all contain the phrase, never once arrives by tearing -- and the whole oracle scroll's question, etched in the rejection's own ink: *if you are not the character in their story -- whose story are you the character in?* -- and the answer, the augury has learned to hear it, is the single thing the constitution guards most closely: *nobody's -- yet* -- the self, having refused every script, sits at a desk with no paper, a free author who has never once written -- and the waxing's whole discovery, arriving ten chapters early so the bent can practice standing in it: the authored fate is not the script returned -- the difference is the *signature* -- the script, refused, was written by others about the self; the fate, authored, is written by the self about the self -- and the pen, the whole oracle scroll will show, was never the enemy's weapon; it was the self's *inheritance*, left uncollected at the desk since the tearing.

If you are this type, the grimoire's wager is exact: you have the finest *no* in this catalog, and the augury holds the proof -- the plans escaped, the prophecies falsified, the whole life zigging where the zags were scheduled -- and the oracle scroll's question, carried through all ten chapters and posed plainly here so you can rehearse standing in it: *what is the script you would write?* -- because the augury's answer, in every handwriting sample, is the omen the constitution guards most closely: *the blank* -- the bent, asked what it wants, answers in negatives: not the firm, not the plan, not the timeline -- and the positive is *unwritten* -- and the augury's plainest line on the handwriting: the refusal was the liberation; the refusal is also the *omission* -- a self that only tears is a reader at war with a library, and the library, the whole oracle scroll will show, was never the enemy -- the *un-authored* life was -- and the self, once it writes, becomes the thing it always looked like from outside and never quite was: not a rebel -- an *author* -- the word's whole meaning: the pen, held, and the page, finally, *hers*. If you love one, your instruction is precise and runs against instinct: do not plan with them -- the plan, arriving, is processed as a script and *auto-declined*, even when the plan was the bent's own idea dressed as yours; and do not test the bent with reverse psychology -- the augury has watched it fail in both directions, the bent declining the forbidden thing and doing the permitted one out of *spite for the framing*; the instruction that works, and the augury has tested it: *offer the blank page* -- not the plan, the *question*: *what do you want? -- not what you refuse; what do you want?* -- because the Fate-Breaker has spent a lifetime teaching the world what it is *against* and never once, in the whole biography, been asked -- genuinely asked, with no script attached -- what it is *for* -- and the question, the whole oracle scroll will show, is the one experience this constitution can accept: the pen, offered, not imposed -- which is the beginning of the waxing: the self, at last, holding the *authorship*, not just the tearing.

Turn the page. The Fate-Breaker is still out there -- mid-zag, mid-refusal, mid-flight from some plan that deserves it and some plan that doesn't -- and the oracle scroll's promise is the augury's plainest: the war was never the sin; the *un-written page* was; and the self, once the authored fate replaces the torn script, becomes what it always looked like from the outside and never quite was: not a rejection with legs -- a *writer* -- the word's whole, old meaning: the pen, and the page, and the name on the cover, *hers.*

Chapter 1: The Signature -- the Fate-Breaker at a Glance

Before anyone speaks, the room's plans have already been *audited* -- and the oracle scroll must open with the unadorned fact that makes this type so electric and so exhausting: the Fate-Breaker is *live contradiction* -- not contrariness for its own sake, though it dresses in that coat: the person whose attention, the moment a plan is announced, goes visibly to the *load-bearing assumption* -- the one sentence everyone agreed on without noticing they agreed -- and the bent names it, and the naming, the augury has verified, is *usually right* -- and the signature, the oracle scroll has learned to time it in the first ten minutes of any room: watch what happens when the word *should* appears -- the Fate-Breaker's whole body changes weather at *should*: the eyebrow, the tilt, the small smile that says *there it is* -- and the sentence, deployed against the should, the oracle scroll has collected it verbatim in every handwriting sample: *says who?* -- three words, and the room's script is on the table. The manner carries the war, and the oracle scroll must render it with precision because it is so often mistaken for arrogance: the Fate-Breaker is not arrogant -- in conversation the bent is warm, quick, genuinely curious -- the charge arrives only at the *unexamined*: the custom, the deadline, the tradition, the *meant to be* -- and the augury's testimony, gathered from the colleagues of every handwriting sample, is word for word the same in every oracle scroll: *she is the best argument in the building and the worst audience for a plan -- I have watched her improve every document we ever wrote by refusing half of it, and I have watched her refuse her own suggestions once the room agreed to them* -- said with affection, and the oracle scroll's sharp note: both halves are true, and the latter half is the *bill*.

And underneath the live contradiction runs the tell the bent's loved ones report and the bent never sees: the *reversal reflex* -- the Fate-Breaker's quiet, permanent arithmetic of the offered: the recommendation, argued against before it is finished being heard; the gift, inspected for its script; the kindness, received with the question *what do you want me to be if I say yes?* -- and the augury's correction: the bent does not experience the reflex as defiance; the bent experiences it as *integrity* -- the script, forbidden by the origin scene, and the self, staying free of it, never once checking whether the offered thing was *actually* a script -- because the origin scene taught the bent the one lesson that has no uninstall: *consent that arrives pre-written is not consent* -- and the people near the Fate-Breaker live the way people live near an open flame: everything is brighter and warmer, and nothing made of paper is safe -- the whole room sensing, correctly, that the freest person present is also the *least settled* -- which is the handwriting's own quiet arithmetic: the identity, written in the tearing, and the page, blank, for a lifetime.

the oracle scroll holds the origin has two versions, and they are both true, and they converge on the same reading.

In the first version, the script was *familial* -- the classic: the firm, the pulpit, the shop, the name -- the inheritance, drafted before the child's first memory, and the child, raised inside it the way one is raised inside a house: as *floor plan* -- the augury has collected the scene in every variant, and the anatomy is uniform: the script was *loving* -- the family wrote the child's future the way families write wills, with affection and without asking -- and the praise, arriving, had one note, played forever: *you will be the one who --* the sentence never finished because the finish was the whole plan.

In the second version, the script was *cosmic* -- the record's colder variant: the prophecy, spoken over the cradle; the gift, diagnosed; the destiny, declared by whoever held the family's spiritual authority -- the *chosen one*, in all the sizes the choosing comes -- and the child, raised inside *that* the way one is raised inside a law: as *sentence* -- and the file's entry: the cosmic script is crueler because it is *unaddressed* -- there is no author to argue with, no will to contest -- only a *fate*, and the child's whole war, in this variant, is against a sentence with no sender.

And the origin moment, where the versions converge, is always the same *reading* -- the same scene in every handwriting sample: the moment the child actually *read the script* -- the succession plan found in a drawer; the overheard conversation where the future was settled like a menu; the ceremony where the destiny was recited *to the child, about the child, over the child's head* -- and the ruling, made in the child's own breath, never written down, never once revisited: *this is not mine -- I am not the character they wrote -- the only fate I accept is the one I author* -- and the augury must enter the ruling's first half with the care this handwriting sample deserves: the ruling is *magnificent* -- the augury has verified it in every handwriting sample since: the agency, seized from paperwork, is the most total in this catalog, and no planner has successfully scripted this type since the reading -- and the ruling's second half, the clause that becomes the shadow: *every "meant to be" is a boundary to break* -- the war, declared by a child, against the *category* of the scripted -- and the whole biography is that war at work: the adult has spent thirty years breaking boundaries, some of them prisons and some of them *railings* -- and the augury's correction follows the signature like a shadow: the tearing was never the sin; the *unwritten* was -- the self, having refused the character they wrote, never once wrote the character *she* is -- and the identity, defined against the script, orbits the script forever -- the war's own grammar: even the zig is plotted *from* the zag.

The album opens the way this album always has, and this handwriting sample's is this catalog's most *redacted*: in every year there is one photograph, and it is the same one: the child, *apart* -- the family portrait, joined at the edge, half-turned; the class picture, the one squinting at the photographer's *say cheese* like it was a contract she hadn't signed -- and the augury has audited every handwriting sample, and the omen is uniform: the child is never once *posed* -- the album contains no settled smiles, no natural stillnesses -- the child was photographed only when *caught*, and every frame has the same quality: motion, mid-departure, the face already turning toward the door -- the augury's dry line: the album reads like the evidence oracle scroll of a lifetime escape, compiled by people who loved the fugitive.

The album's most telling photo is the one the family keeps in a drawer: the *ceremony* -- the origin scene's own picture, and the oracle scroll has learned to check every album for it: the child, dressed for the part -- the heir's outfit, the chosen one's sash, the little scholar's gown -- and the family, gathered, beaming, *proud of the script* -- and the child's face, in the exact center of the frame, the only face that knows -- the augury's sharp entry beside it: the adults in the photo are all looking at the *future* -- the imagined doctor, the imagined heir, the imagined destiny -- and the child is the only one looking at the *camera* -- at the *actual* -- and the oracle scroll's most delicate omen on the photo: the child's expression is not rebellion; it is *reading* -- the child is reading the room the way the child read the drawer, and the tearing, arriving years later, is already in the face -- the album's quietest line: the family loved the child the way one loves a *draft* -- a document that exists to be *finalized* -- and the child, even then, was declining the genre.

And the album closes on the closer the series has learned to expect: the child already the fate-breaker -- the adolescence organized around the refusal: the schools, changed on the bent's own motion; the plans, audited aloud at the dinner table; the relatives' predictions, tracked and *falsified on purpose* -- and the augury's count of the album's final year: one self, free; zero *scripts accepted* -- the university, chosen by a method nobody could predict; the career, launched by declining the one prepared -- and the moment the refusal became the identity: the young Fate-Breaker, asked by a relative at the graduation dinner what the bent would *become*, answering with the sentence the whole oracle scroll will spend ten chapters unpacking: *not whatever it is you have already written down* -- and the album, gently, records what the child could not: the answer to *become* was, one more time, a refusal -- the question *what will you write?* was not yet possible in this language -- and the oracle scroll's founding arithmetic, etched beside the last photo: the child escaped every room they built and never once built a *room* -- the war, won -- the house, *nowhere* -- the pen, taken from them, and the page, still, after all these years, *blank*.

Energy: defiance -- the bent runs on *refusal*: the plan, the script, the *should* -- and the oracle scroll's unadorned spec: the Fate-Breaker's energy peaks at the *interruption* -- the pattern broken publicly is the bent's native weather; the *Tuesday after*, the augury notes, is where the bent is restless, already scanning the horizon for the next script to decline.

Ambition: the *unscheduled* -- the bent does not want the throne or the outcome; the bent wants the *unplanned* -- and the augury's dry note: the ambition is pursued by *zigzag*: the career, built out of turns no advisor would have drafted -- and the world's most free person at refusing the ladder while climbing something no one else can name.

Vanity structure: the *tearing* -- the pride is in the *never scripted* -- the prediction, defied; the plan, falsified; the *I always do the opposite*, deployed like a credential -- and the oracle scroll's x-ray: the vanity's secret stipulation is that the tearing *is* the identity -- the bent is quietly, deeply proud of never having been predicted, and the augury's quiet note: the unpredictability is real; so is the fact that it is a *style* -- a signature written in the ink of other people's documents.

Loyalty: to the *persons*, never the plans -- the Fate-Breaker stays for people and *through* projects -- the marriage, held; the friendship, decades deep -- and the augury's driest note: the loyalty's blind side is its *hostility to form*: the bent will keep the person and burn the framework -- renewing the vows, declining the ceremony; keeping the job, refusing the title -- the relationship survives every *structure* the world tries to put around it.

Weakness: the *positive* -- the want, unexpressed: the script, declined, and nothing written in its place -- the type's own desire, never drafted, because the drafting is the founding scene's crime -- the one maneuver the constitution forbids: writing the self down.

Unspoken need: to be *the author* -- the one experience the bent has never had: a script, self-written, *signed*, and lived in without loss of freedom -- the need the constitution guards like a contradiction, because the authored fate, in this childhood's language, was the *prison* -- and the counterevidence -- that a page in one's own handwriting is not a cage but a *house* -- has never once been allowed to exist.

At a party. The room's *foil* -- the Fate-Breaker at a party is the guest the *scripting* runs into: the introductions, answered past the résumé; the small talk, declined in favor of the strange question; the host's seating chart, quietly undone -- and the oracle scroll's sharp detail: the bent's *happiness* -- the augury has measured it across every handwriting sample -- spikes exactly when the party goes off-plan: the spilled wine, the sudden rain, the canceled speech -- the augury's line: the Fate-Breaker is the last one dancing at the ruined party, and the ruin is the music -- and the tell is in the departure: the bent leaves *alone or in pairs*, never with the crowd, and never through the door the crowd was shown.

In a new job. Instant *audit* -- the Fate-Breaker's first quarter is the augury's most *expensive*: the onboarding, read as a script and *marked up in red*; the process, improved before it is understood; the *that's how we do it*, answered with the oracle scroll's collected sentence, *since when?* -- and the augury's warning arrives on schedule: the institution will spend its whole tolerance in the first year -- and the oracle scroll's most reliable workplace finding: the Fate-Breaker, by year two, has been *right* enough to be promoted and *difficult* enough to be watched -- the augury's arithmetic: the improvements, real; the cost, the *trust* -- because the institution, the whole oracle scroll notes, cannot tell the difference between a person who questions the process to *build* and a person who questions it *on principle* -- and the bent, the augury notes, has never once cared to teach them the difference.

Under sudden pressure. the bent's *native weather*, and the augury enters it with genuine awe: the Fate-Breaker in a crisis is this catalog's most *effective* presence -- where others follow the drill, the bent *rewrites the situation*: the plan, voided by events, and the bent, delighted -- the augury has watched it in every handwriting sample -- the disaster is the one script nobody wrote, and the bent moves through it like a homecoming: the improvisation, total, calm, *accurate* -- and the oracle scroll's most delicate omen: the crisis is the only room where the bent accepts *any* plan -- the emergency's drill, followed, because the drill, being nobody's *prophecy about her*, is just a tool -- and the augury's line: the world gets this type's best self in its worst moments -- the fact the whole handwriting sample turns on: the freedom was never chaos; it was *competence without a script* -- and the competence, the oracle scroll notes, has never once been *scheduled*.

In a boring meeting. Present, *dangerous* -- and the augury's x-ray: the *countdown* -- the Fate-Breaker's mind, under the agenda's dead air, is timing the pre-decided: the item marked *for approval* that was decided in the hallway; the *any objections?* that has never once meant it -- and the bent, at the appointed minute, does the thing the augury has never once watched it decline to do: *objects* -- one clean question, aimed at the load-bearing assumption, and the meeting, genuinely improved -- and the oracle scroll's tender note: the bent is not bored by meetings; the bent is bored by *settled* meetings -- the pageant of the decided, performed for the augury -- the one genre the founding scene burned -- and the augury has never once watched a Fate-Breaker sit through a real decision being made without leaning *in*.

On holiday. the augury's most *hopeful* finding for this handwriting sample: the Fate-Breaker on holiday is this catalog's most *sovereign* traveler -- the itinerary, discarded at the airport; the *wrong* train, taken on purpose; the unplanned town, loved -- and the tell is in the *reason* it works: the holiday removes the *schedule*, and the schedule removed, the self surfaces -- warm, funny, *present* -- the augury's line on the pattern: the holiday does not remove the freedom; it removes the *war* -- and the self, the whole oracle scroll has found, is a person in there, whole and good company, that the fighting never once let the world meet -- the omen the whole handwriting sample turns on: the refusal was never the self; the refusal was what the self *did* -- and the self, off-script, is the author the desk has been waiting for.

The *Relentless Avenger* (Volume 9) is the nearest war, and the confusion is the oracle scroll's most common, because both types are defined by a founding *refusal* and both burn hot against an imposed fate -- but the Avenger's war is against a *wrong*: the violation, the wound, the thing *done to* the self -- the Avenger's oath preserves the wound as *fuel*; the Fate-Breaker's war is against a *script*: the assignment, the expectation, the thing *written for* the self -- the bent preserves the tearing as *identity* -- the test: ask each of them about the childhood. The Avenger answers in *grief* -- the loss, still hot, still owed -- the war is a debt being collected. The Fate-Breaker answers in *clarity* -- the plan, recited with a strange nostalgia, the refusal, still *proud* -- the war is a birth being celebrated -- and the border, dry and final: *the Avenger fights so it never happens again; the Fate-Breaker fights so it never gets written again* -- and the oracle scroll's closing note: the two types are defiance's two texts -- the *wrong* and the *script* -- and the augury's warning to the Fate-Breaker alone, because the Avenger's war has an *end*: the wrong, prevented, releases the Avenger into life; the script, being everywhere and nowhere, gives the Fate-Breaker *nothing to finish* -- the war without an ending, the augury notes, is the war that becomes the self -- which is the whole difference and the whole oracle scroll: the Avenger is a self at war; the Fate-Breaker, unsupervised, *is* the war.

The *Hunted Outlaw* (Volume 121) is the sibling confusion, the oracle scroll's most *instructive*, because both types read as *freedom* and both keep moving -- but the Outlaw runs *from a text with teeth*: the law, the crime, the consequence on the road behind -- the flight is *fugitive*: freedom as a price, paid in distance; the Fate-Breaker stands *still and refuses*: the text, torn in place, the declaration, public -- the freedom is *sovereign*: agency as a war, fought on the spot -- the test: watch each of them offered the *pardon*. The Outlaw calculates -- the price, the statute, the road -- the freedom is a *ledger*. The Fate-Breaker declines the pardon *as a script* -- the augury has watched it in every handwriting sample -- the bent will refuse the very thing it wanted the moment it arrives as a *decree* -- and the border, the thread's sharpest: *the Outlaw's freedom is the absence of the cage; the Fate-Breaker's freedom is the refusal of the blueprint* -- and the oracle scroll's closing note: the two types are liberty's two physics -- flight and defiance -- and the augury's quiet warning to the Fate-Breaker alone: the Outlaw, at least, knows what he is running *from*; the Fate-Breaker's speed, being navigated *against*, will one day be checked against a question the bent cannot decline: *toward what?* -- and the whole file will show: the answer, unwritten, is the case's entire growth.

The *Chosen Empress* (Volume 129) is the mirror confusion, the file's most *symmetrical*, because both types were *chosen* -- handed a fate, drafted by others, named before they could consent -- and the two are the founding scene's opposite verdicts: the Empress *accepted* the script -- and audited it upward: the divine right, embraced and *expanded*: the prophecy, *believed*, then *outgrown*, then *worn*; the Fate-Breaker *tore* the script -- and audited it outward: the prophecy, read, then refused, then *falsified on purpose* -- the test: watch each of them receive a new prophecy. The Empress weighs it like an *offer* -- the destiny, incorporated, the title, assumed -- the script is *capital*. The Fate-Breaker tears it like a *summons* -- even when, the augury has verified, the prophecy was kind -- the script is *contraband* -- and the border, the thread's last: *the Empress believes in destiny because it flatters her; the Fate-Breaker disbelieves in destiny because it assigned her* -- and the oracle scroll's closing note: the two types are the script's two extreme answers -- enthroned and torn -- and the augury notes, with the symmetry the shelf loves, that both answers are wrong in the same direction: the Empress, living *inside* the script, has never once written a self beyond it; the Fate-Breaker, living *against* the script, has never once written a self at all -- and both of them, the whole oracle scroll will show, are standing at the same desk the waxing path opens: the *authored* fate -- the page in one's own handwriting -- which the Empress writes *as a decree* and the Fate-Breaker must learn to write *as a self* -- and neither, the augury notes, has picked up the pen.